Tenzin Gyaltsen

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Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — Cambridge, MA
Master of Science in Technology and Policy — *Aug. 2025 – Expected May 2027*

- Relevant coursework: Deep Learning, Ethical ML, ML Modeling

Macalester College — Saint Paul, MN
Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science, Political Science — *Aug. 2020 – May 2024*

Experience

Graduate Fellow — Oct. 2025 – Dec. 2025
Technology and Policy Program and Decentralized Internet Group, CSAIL — *Cambridge, MA*

- Researched privacy frameworks for LLMs, including Differential Privacy and software architecture techniques for building privacy-preserving chatbots
- Collaborated with Principal Research Scientist Lalana Kagal to develop a proof-of-concept chatbot and supporting database for evaluating privacy leakage
- Analyzed privacy risks specific to conversational and language-based AI systems, focusing on prompt leakage and sensitive data memorization in LLM interactions

Software Engineering Intern — May 2023 – Aug. 2023
Uber Technologies Inc. — *San Francisco, CA*

- Redesigned a legacy audience tracking service by decoupling it from the main API and replacing continuous queries with scheduled batch updates, cutting annual service costs from $40K USD to $4.5K USD
- Built gRPC endpoints and Kafka streaming pipelines to ingest and store audience data, structured by audienceID and UUID, replacing REST endpoints and enabling efficient cron job for Uber's CRM workflows
- Optimized delta computation algorithm using advanced hashing and batching calls, preventing memory overload while scaling audience calculations from 150M to 1B records
- Applied Test-Driven Development and orchestrated incremental shadow rollout, writing unit and edge-case tests with JUnit and Mockito, and validating 95% real-time data consistency with 10x less computation
- Collaborated closely with senior engineers, reviewed system design, PRs, and team projects to ensure alignment and best practices across the development lifecycle
- Gained experience deploying and maintaining data-intensive systems that support downstream machine learning and personalization workflows

Projects

Spotify DB Emulator | *MYSQL, MariaDB* | Github Repository — Mar. 2023 – May 2023

- Engineered and designed Spotify Emulator DB to build foundational knowledge of database systems
- Designed Logical Data Structures using relationship schemas with 70 entities and studied query optimizations
- Built on MariaDB SQL, accurately tested 100+ queries that would emulate an ingestion-ready Spotify DB

LLM Experiments and Fine-Tuning | *Python, PyTorch, LLM APIs* | Github Repository — Jan. 2025 – Present

- Experimented with LLM prompting and fine-tuning workflows
- Explored multilingual and low-resource language inputs to evaluate model generalization and behavior

Technical Skills

Related Coursework: Deep Learning, OOP, Data Structures and Algorithms, Discrete Math, Linear Algebra, DBMS
Technical Languages: Python, Java, SQL, JavaScript, C++, R, Swift, HTML/CSS
Frameworks: React, JUnit, Spring MVC
Developer Tools: Git, CI/CD, REST API, gRPC, Apache Kafka, Cadence, Grafana, AWS, uDeploy (Jenkins)
Libraries: PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Sci-Kit Learn, ggplot, Maven, Log4j, Mockito
Languages: Tibetan (Native), English (Professional), Hindi (Conversational)

Achievements and Awards

Dean's List | *Macalester College* — Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024

GTPN Hackathon | *2nd Place* — Aug. 2023

Horizon Foundation Scholar | *United World College - USA* — 2018

Leaderships

Sontsa Initiative Mentorship | *Founding Co-Director* — May 2020 – May 2023

- Co-founded a mentorship project that mentored 500+ Tibetan students, expanding access to higher education for an underrepresented linguistic community